

Leopoldo López Gil presents his book "La vida sigue, la lucha continúa" (Life Goes On, the Struggle Continues) at the European Parliament: three generations committed to Venezuelan democracy

The father of Venezuelan opposition leader Leopoldo López publishes a 300-page historical testimony that traces the history of Venezuela from the 18th century to the present, interweaving family memory and political struggle

Brussels, September 30th, 2026 – Leopoldo López Gil today presented his book "**La vida sigue, la lucha continúa**" (Editorial Temple) at the Library of the European Parliament in Brussels. The autobiographical work stands as a fundamental testimony to Venezuela's democratic history and to the commitment of three generations of one family to freedom and justice.

The presentation at the European Parliament

One of the central themes of his address was the role of education in the development and rebuilding of societies. López Gil recalled his experience at the head of the **Gran Mariscal de Ayacucho Scholarship Program**, which in 1974 enabled thousands of young Venezuelans to study at international universities, and drew a parallel with the European **Erasmus** program for its capacity to transform generations and contribute to the progress of nations.

López Gil named education, knowledge, respect and tolerance among the pillars needed to build prosperous societies and to rebuild those that have suffered institutional decline, linking this idea to Venezuela.

In this context, López Gil stressed the importance of strengthening political, cultural and institutional ties between the European Union and Latin America, a relationship in which, in his view, Spain can play a particularly important role as a bridge between the two regions, and called for closer cooperation around shared principles such as the rule of law, public freedoms and respect for democratic institutions.

With **300 pages** that include historical newspaper material from the National Newspaper Library in Caracas (Hemeroteca Nacional), the book spans the period from the 18th century to the present day, documenting how a lineage of Venezuelans took an active part in building the country's democracy, facing dictatorships, exile and a constant struggle to preserve republican institutions.

A story of generational commitment

"La vida sigue, la lucha continúa" is not only one man's memoir, but the story of a conviction passed down from generation to generation. **The author's grandfather, Dr. Eudoro López**, lived in exile in Colombia during the dictatorship of Juan Vicente Gómez. From there, in 1932, he wrote prophetic

words to his son: *"A social movement is now under way in the world that is transforming the political order, and Venezuela will surely take part in this healthy transformation."*

His father, Leopoldo López Ortega, carried on that legacy by taking part in building the democratic Venezuela restored in 1958, while **his son, Leopoldo López**, former mayor in Caracas and leader of the Venezuelan opposition, has continued the same struggle in the 21st century, paying for his commitment to freedom with years in prison.

From a country of 4 million to the diaspora: Venezuela's transformation

Born in Caracas in 1944, Leopoldo López Gil witnessed firsthand Venezuela's dizzying transformation: a country that went from 4 million inhabitants and only 8,000 university students to designing a university campus for 15,000 students that would eventually host more than 50,000.

The author devotes especially moving pages to the **Gran Mariscal de Ayacucho Scholarship Program**, which in its first year sent thousands of Venezuelan students abroad, and whose participants he affectionately calls "the Ayacuchos": young people in whom were sown "renewed hope and the commitment to building a country where justice, prosperity and, above all, freedom would flourish."

Yet, as López Gil himself lucidly acknowledges, the country "did not grow in a straight line: it advanced in dizzying leaps" which "also brought social imbalances," until "a democracy restored in 1958 was lost forty years later."

Education as the common thread

A central theme of the book is the conviction that education is the foundation of citizenship and the key to building a prosperous and just society. López Gil describes how, "from generation to generation, the commitment was passed on to foster a social participation that would bring prosperity, justice and freedom, built through the thread of education."

This vision runs through the entire work: from the intellectual upbringing he received in his family, where "Venezuela was never an abstraction" but part of "daily conversation and concrete concerns," to his own involvement in educational institutions and his commitment to training new generations of Venezuelans.

Memory, exile and resistance

The book is especially relevant in the current context of the Venezuelan diaspora. Written in Madrid, where López Gil now lives, the work grew out of a revealing moment: "One afternoon, already far from Venezuela, I opened a box that had come with the hurried move (...) Inside were letters, documents, and at the very bottom, a thick unmarked envelope. They were photographs."

From that encounter with memory came this project: "I understood that memory is not just remembrance; it is projection. What we have lived is understanding,

order and the passing on of what we have learned. Experience only becomes legacy when it is passed on and sustained by the truth."

For López Gil, writing this book has not been an exercise in nostalgia, but a need "to bear witness to a lineage of Venezuelans who, from different fields and responsibilities, took an active part in the task of building a country" and to pass on a fundamental lesson: "commitment to one's country is not a circumstantial decision, but a way of life passed down from generation to generation, a moral inheritance that obliges us to rise to the demands of our time and our commitment."

A unique visual testimony

The book includes extraordinary historical photographs from Leopoldo López Gil's personal archive and from the National Newspaper Library in Caracas. This visual material makes the work not only a personal testimony but a historical document of the first order on 20th-century Venezuela.

One family, many influences

Throughout its pages, López Gil pays tribute to the people who shaped him: his sister Edith, whose "deep passion for history" awakened in him "an early curiosity about historical processes"; his sister Diana, who passed on to him "an intense relationship with Venezuelan music"; his sister Julieta, from whom he received "spirituality and a love of literature"; his mother, who taught him "a love of Venezuelan culinary and gastronomic traditions"; and his father, who instilled in him both "a love of the fine arts" and a social conscience, taking him from an early age "to visit public hospitals in need of improvement" so that he would understand "that public service should be aimed at easing those realities."

He also dedicates special words to his father-in-law Eduardo, Minister of Agriculture at just 29, whose "deep love for Venezuela was not worn down by the years or by disappointment," and to his wife Antonieta, whom he describes as "my everyday companion and strength in every circumstance."

A message of hope

Despite recounting decades of struggle, setbacks and exile, the book's title carries an unmistakable message of continuity and hope: "Life goes on, the struggle continues." For López Gil, as long as there are Venezuelans committed to democracy and freedom, the generational handover ensures that the story is not over.

The book closes with a meaningful dedication: it is dedicated to Antonieta, his children, his grandchildren, "and to those young people we call Ayacuchos, in whom were sown renewed hope and the commitment to building a country where justice, prosperity and, above all, freedom would flourish."

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Leopoldo López Gil was born in Caracas in 1944. An economist by training, he has devoted his life to public service and to the defense of democratic institutions in Venezuela. He is the father of Venezuelan opposition leader Leopoldo López, former mayor in Caracas, and the grandfather of a new generation committed to restoring democracy in their country.

His professional career includes a prominent role in educational and development projects, always guided by the conviction that education is the fundamental basis for building a just and prosperous society.

He sits on the Higher Councils of the Metropolitana and Simón Bolívar universities, is Professor Emeritus at the Universidad Tecnológica del Centro, and President of Educredito and of the Centro Venezolano Americano. He is a member of the Editorial Board of El Nacional and The Daily Journal, a member of the Higher Council of the La Salle Foundation, and a member of the Boards of Directors of Protinal, Venceramica, Grupo Boulton and Consolidada de Cementos.

In 2019 he was elected a Member of the European Parliament for Spain on the Partido Popular list. As an MEP in the 9th parliamentary term, he served as Vice-Chair of the Delegation to the EU Joint Parliamentary Committee, member of the Subcommittee on Human Rights and member of the Delegation to the Euro-Latin American Parliamentary Assembly.

He currently lives in Madrid, where he continues his commitment to the Venezuelan democratic cause and the defense of human rights.

His book "La vida sigue, la lucha continúa" was presented on May 29th, 2026 at the Ateneo de Madrid and on September 30th, 2026 at the European Parliament in Brussels. In June 2026, Leopoldo López Gil also held a book signing at the Madrid Book Fair.

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

The four López generations

First generation: Dr. Eudoro López

Lived in exile during the dictatorship of Juan Vicente Gómez (1908-1935). From Colombia, he wrote to his son about his hope for Venezuela's democratic transformation.

Second generation: Leopoldo López Ortega (the author's father)

Took an active part in building Venezuelan democracy after 1958. He instilled in his children a love of culture and the arts and a commitment to public service.

Third generation: Leopoldo López Gil (the author)

Economist, witness to Venezuela's dizzying transformation from the 1950s to the 1990s, committed to the country's education and development.

Fourth generation: Leopoldo López

Former mayor of the Chacao municipality in Caracas (2000-2008), leader of the Venezuelan opposition and founder of the Voluntad Popular party. He was imprisoned from 2014 to 2017 and held under house arrest until he left Venezuela in 2020.

The Gran Mariscal de Ayacucho Scholarship Program

Created in 1974 during the first government of Carlos Andrés Pérez, it was one of the most ambitious scholarship programs in Latin America. In its first year it sent thousands of young Venezuelans to study at the best universities in the world. These "Ayacuchos," as López Gil affectionately calls them, were a generation of highly qualified professionals who returned home hoping to build a prosperous, modern Venezuela.

HIGHLIGHTED QUOTES

- "Memory is not just remembrance; it is projection. What we have lived is understanding, order and the passing on of what we have learned."
 - "Commitment to one's country is not a circumstantial decision, but a way of life passed down from generation to generation."
 - "In my family, Venezuela was never an abstraction. It was part of our daily conversation and our concrete concerns."
 - "The country did not grow in a straight line: it advanced in dizzying leaps. Leaps, however, that also brought social imbalances and, sadly, led us to lose our way. And so, a democracy restored in 1958 was lost within forty years."
 - "Public life is not a stage for self-promotion, but a sphere of dedication and service."
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AVAILABILITY FOR INTERVIEWS

Leopoldo López Gil is available for print, radio and television interviews. To arrange an interview or request press copies, please contact:

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BOOK DETAILS

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BOOK PRESENTATION

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Venue: Library of the European Parliament

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Format: Presentation by the author, introduced by Esteban González Pons, Member and Vice-President of the European Parliament, with the participation of MEP Antonio López Istúriz.

SOCIAL MEDIA

Twitter/X: @LeopoldoLopezG

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Campaign hashtags:

#LaVidaSigueLaLuchaContinúa

#LeopoldoLópezGil

#DemocraciaVenezuela

#LibertadVenezuela
